

Devin about his financial irresponsibility, maybe he would have been forced to confront the reasons why he was so careless. If she had denied him assistance, Devin would have been forced to solve his own dilemma. Like a child learning to ride a bike, Devin would have most certainly fallen several times at first, but eventually he would have learned to ride steadily on his own.

### **America: Home of the Free—But Not For Free**

Collecting money you have lent to a friend is hard enough. When you add the extra complication of having to retrieve it from someone who has left the country, it is almost impossible. Legally, there is little that the courts can do when the borrower has left their jurisdiction. If the borrower returns, they will find bad credit or lawsuits await them. If they have no intention of returning, this is not a deterrent.

You may feel that lending money to a friend or relative from another country is a safe proposition. They are family, you convince yourself; they will never abandon me with their debts. Maria felt she would have no problem when she decided to loan her relatives money.

Maria had immigrated to the United States from the Philippines seven years ago when she was just sixteen years old. She was sent to live with a distant relative so that she could go to school in America and receive a good education. At first, she missed her family desperately, but over time she made friends and started to feel comfortable in her adopted country.

After graduation from high school, Maria had to choose between working full-time and going on to college. Since her family was struggling financially in the Philippines, she decided to work and send her family as much of her salary as

